

CM529 PROJECT ARCHIVE

MARINA XU



EVERYDAY
gourmet

REFLECTION #1

Looking back on Project 1, I think the most valuable thing I've learned is the step-by-step process of how to actually build a brand. Even before designing, reading about how big brands like the Olympics or Perplexity arrive at their final designs gave me a clearer sense of how branding is done through different aspects. From research to concept, design to presentation, every single step is necessary and important.

I used to think that designing is purely art, but quite the opposite – the first essential part is research. I remember my initial pitch was to build a campaign that promotes local farm produce. It sounded very interesting, but the reality hit when I was only able to find on average two produces at the stores that are from local farms.

But thanks to the neighborhood trip I made, I was able to fully feel the vibe of these local grocery stores, see interactions between customers and the workers, walk through aisles of surprising goods and engage with the community they have in the shops. I was able to come up with another campaign idea of how these beautiful local gourmet grocery stores can really change people's expectations of ordinary grocery shopping. With what I've seen and felt, I was more excited than ever that I could build a campaign based on something I enjoy.

Throughout the project, I had to make a lot of second edits when I know more information or have better ideas. But it was that back-and-forth process that helped the most in improving my ideas and designs. Comparing different directions helped me see what worked and what didn't, those choices helped in making my final design stronger.

Another major takeaway for me was learning how closely design connects to the target market. During the brand analysis, I realized how much strategy is behind every small design choice. I used to think a logo just needed to look nice or unique, but now I see that every detail – color, typography, personality – reflects who the brand is speaking to. A toy brand wouldn't use minimalist greys, and a pharmaceutical company wouldn't go for a cute or splashy look. There's always reasoning behind these choices, and understanding that helped me see designs in a storytelling perspective rather than just a decoration.

Having a personal interest in my own campaign is another thing that helped a lot in making this project better. I love grocery shopping, and I think of it as my peaceful alone time. Visiting those local grocery stores was fun and enjoyable for myself, either discovering new ones or re-visiting the ones I've been. Walking through the stores physically – the handwritten signs, the welcoming environment, the way how everything was displayed – gave me inspirations I couldn't have gotten from online research.

For the future, I just want to keep practicing. I'd love to explore different markets and try designing for different needs like something in fashion, film or non-profit. Each audience has its own visual language, and I want to keep learning how to translate ideas into designs that truly fit the people they're meant for.

REFLECTION #2

When I started working on the website and app designs, the hardest part was figuring out what content actually belonged on each platform. I wasn't sure how to structure the pages or what information made sense where. Doing website and app audits helped a lot – looking at different grocery store sites, apps, and some well-structured designs gave me ideas for how to separate content, organize sections, and think about my own visual direction.

Once I decided what I wanted the website and app to do, things became much clearer. The website would focus on information and storytelling, while the app would be centered around usability, convenience, and everyday interaction. After sketching rough drafts on paper, the layout and flow came together more smoothly, and building everything in Figma felt natural again after a short refresh from previous classes. The designing and prototyping process went pretty smoothly once the foundation was set.

After finishing the overall design, I spent time adjusting smaller details, so every element matched the overall vibe of my campaign. Those refinements made the design feel more cohesive and intentional.

During my critique session with Mary, she suggested that I could tie sustainability into my campaign as an additional supporting idea – not to replace any section, but to reinforce why local grocery stores matter. I thought it was an amazing idea, and I added sustainability into the campaign description and include a small section about it on my “Our Story” page. The idea of sustainability added another meaningful layer and helped clarify the values behind Everyday Gourmet.

Overall, this part of the project helped me think more intentionally about structure, user needs, and how website and app design work together. It also helped me realize how much clearer the process becomes once I define the purpose of each platform and sketch out ideas first.

CAMPAIGN RESEARCH & ANALYSIS

Campaign

I will be addressing the lack of excitement in conventional grocery shopping for young professionals and families in Cambridge, by highlighting the vibrant produce and specialty goods found in local gourmet grocery stores.

Target Market–Segment or Industry

1. Note characteristics, hotspots, atmosphere, current visuals. What makes this market unique?

- Many people think of grocery shopping as boring and routine, but Cambridge's local gourmet grocery stores feel completely different. Walking in, you find fresh, colorful vegetables labeled with names and locations of nearby farms, giving every item a story. Shelves are lined with specialty goods made from local ingredients, things you won't find in big chain supermarkets. These stores highlight both everyday essentials and unique treats, so shoppers can pick up their regular groceries while discovering something special.
- The atmosphere is warm, inviting, and personal—less businessy than large grocery chains. All these shops have handwritten signs, carefully arranged produce displays, and interiors that feel cozy and well-designed rather than overwhelming. Instead of anonymous packaging, products often come with background stories about the farmer, maker, or family business behind them.

2. What are the strongest selling points for this market? What are the segment/industry's weaknesses?

Strongest selling points:

- fresh, high-quality produce with clear labeling of farm and origin, making shopping feel transparent and personal
- Unique specialty goods made from local ingredients that shoppers cannot find in chain stores
- Engaging, vibrant atmosphere that makes grocery shopping an enjoyable and inspiring experience
- Strong connection to community and local culture, giving shoppers a sense of belonging and fulfillment during the visits

Weaknesses:

- Perception of being expensive or niche, which may scare away budget-conscious shoppers
- Low awareness and low profile, residents not knowing about these stores or what makes them special

- Smaller scale and selection compared to large chains, causing shoppers to choose elsewhere because of convenience
3. What are you hoping to achieve through this campaign? List a few goals that will impact this market.
- Increase awareness and visibility of Cambridge's local gourmet grocery stores
 - Encourage shoppers to explore these stores for both fresh produce and local specialty items
 - Highlight the joy and excitement of grocery shopping, showing how everyday experience can also be inspiring
 - Promote community support by introducing shoppers to local farms, artisans and small businesses

Target Market–Segment or Industry

1. Describe the person you will market this campaign towards. Note age, occupation, income, and lifestyle (such as living location, mode of transportation, etc.).

- The campaign is aimed at a 27-year-old young professional living in Cambridge. She works in finance and earns around \$55,000 annually, making her budget-conscious but willing to pay for quality and small indulgences. She lives in a small studio or shared apartment in the city, relies mainly on public transportation (bus or T), and enjoys experiences that make her daily routine feel a little more inspiring.

2. What type of social media does this person use?

- She uses Instagram most of the time for social interactions and TikTok to get entertainment or food related contents and recommendations. She also uses RedNote (Chinese informational social media)

3. What types of music does this person listen to?

- She listens to soft pops, sometimes also instrumental music.

4. What websites or apps does this person use?

- She uses YouTube to watch lifestyle and recipe videos, uses Eventbrite to know about popular events happening around the town, and uses Yelp to find high rating restaurants and cafes.

5. What shows does this person watch?

- She watches classic sitcoms like *How I Met Your Mother*, popular shows like *Game of Thrones*, and reality shows like *Culinary Wars*.

Media Strategy

1. *What is the theme of your campaign? How do you hope to achieve the goals you listed above?*

- The theme of this campaign is “Everyday Gourmet” - showcasing how local grocery stores in Cambridge turn routine shopping into a joyful, inspiring, and culturally rich experience. The campaign emphasizes that these stores are not just places to buy groceries, but spaces where shoppers can discover fresh, colorful produce, specialty goods, and the stories behind them.
- The campaign will achieve its goals by:
- Highlighting the unique products and experiences that set the stores apart from chain supermarkets
- Showcasing the freshness, quality and local origins of produce and specialty goods to shift perceptions that shopping locally is expensive or inconvenient
- Using visual storytelling and engaging media like Instagram, TikTok or RedNote to present the vibrant atmosphere, human connections and neighborhood characters of the stores
- Encouraging exploration and community support by presenting these grocery stores as accessible, approachable and exciting destinations for everyday shopping

2. *Elaborate on plans for images, copy, & media examples.*

- There will be images on fresh produce & specialty items, lifestyle shots (shopping at the stores or cooking at home with the ingredients), store atmosphere (interiors and handwritten signs or labels) and community & storytelling (farmers and artisans, people interacting with each other).
- Copy will be in a warm, approachable and friendly tone. Key messaging will include words like fresh, local, unique, community, discovery and inspiration to convey the emotional and practical values of the stores.
- There will be social media posts of quick recipe videos using store products, store spotlights or virtual tours, short interviews with farmers and local artisans, and occasional short stories behind store products.

3. *Make loose preliminary notes/plans for the informative website and app. While the website should be informative on your campaign, what might the use be for the app for your target market?*

- The website serves as the hub of information; it will have store directories, product highlights and seasonal specials. There will also be written recipes, community stories, and some eye-catching visuals.
- The app would be more of a convenient and interactive platform where the users can build personalized recommendations based on their likes or dislikes. There

will be click-and-go store navigations and community pages to interact with each other. There can also be useful tools related, like meal/recipe planners and notification alerts.

Design Strategy

1. Make loose notes on design style. For example, do you plan on a more maximal or minimal design approach? What characteristics or styles do you want to use?

- Overall it will be minimal but warm designs. I also want to add a touch of playfulness and personality with handwritten or casual typography to resonate with the store vibes. The colors will be vibrant, soft and natural.
- Image treatments will be rich but natural, with light editings.

Critical Analysis

1. Which part of this project overall do you anticipate presenting the biggest challenges? How can you prepare yourself to overcome these challenges?

- The biggest challenge in this project will likely be changing perceptions. Many people see grocery shopping—especially at local stores—as an inconvenient and boring routine. Convincing shoppers that Cambridge’s local gourmet stores offer both practicality and excitement will require careful messaging, convincing visuals, and warm storytelling.
- To overcome this, I would conduct thorough research and visits to different local stores to observe and learn. I would need to find visuals that are most convincing to create a warm and fun environment for shoppers to visit. I would need to highlight not only the practical benefits like freshness, quality and variety, but also the emotional values like connections with the local community, small indulgences on gourmet items, and fun experiences in discovering.

ASSET COLLECTION

Campaign Description

This campaign highlights Cambridge's local gourmet grocery stores and their ability to transform routine shopping into an inspiring, joyful, and culturally rich experience. Many people see grocery shopping as boring or inconvenient, but these stores offer a unique environment where fresh, colorful produce is labeled with the names and locations of nearby farms, and specialty goods made from local ingredients bring delight and discovery to every visit. Shoppers can pick up everyday essentials while exploring products that tell stories about the farmers, artisans, and families behind them.

These stores are warm, inviting, and personal, with cozy interiors, carefully arranged displays, and handwritten signs that create a welcoming atmosphere. They also prioritize sustainability in small but meaningful ways—prioritizing seasonal produce, partnering with nearby farms, reducing transportation waste, and embracing packaging choices that support a healthier local ecosystem. Unlike chain supermarkets, these stores connect shoppers to the community and to the land it depends on, offering both practical benefits—freshness, quality, and variety—and emotional rewards like the joy of discovering new items or supporting local businesses. This combination makes grocery shopping feel engaging, approachable, and fulfilling.

The campaign, themed *"Everyday Gourmet,"* will showcase its uniqueness through visual storytelling, social media, and digital platforms. Instagram and TikTok will feature quick recipe videos, store spotlights, and interviews with local farmers and artisans. The website will serve as an informative hub with store directories, product highlights, seasonal specials, recipes, community stories, and insights into how these stores source responsibly. The app will offer personalized recommendations, meal planners, store navigation, and community interaction, helping young professionals and families make local grocery shopping both practical and inspiring.

By emphasizing everyday convenience, sustainability, and the small excitements available in these stores, the goal of the campaign is to increase awareness, encourage exploration of local products, highlight the joy of shopping, and promote support for Cambridge's farms, artisans, and small businesses. Ultimately, this campaign redefines grocery shopping as a rewarding experience—turning routine errands into opportunities for discovery, connection, and delight.

Elevator Pitch

Grocery shopping doesn't have to be boring. Cambridge's local gourmet stores offer fresh, colorful produce and local specialties that let you explore the city's flavors and community with every visit.

Campaign Goals

- Increase awareness of Cambridge's local gourmet grocery stores and what makes them unique
- Encourage people to explore local stores for fresh produce and specialty items, turning shopping into an inspiring experience
- Highlight the joy and excitement of grocery shopping, showing how everyday errands can be fulfilling
- Promote community support by connecting shoppers to local farms, artisans, and small businesses

BRAND ANALYSIS - 1



Brand - A24

A24 is an independent entertainment company producing and distributing films and TV shows. Its film styles appeal to audiences who want bold, creative, and unconventional storytelling.

A24 is both a film studio and a lifestyle brand, with strong influence on youth culture. They are trying to turn indie films into mainstream, showcasing cultural, experimental or niche stories.

Defining characteristics of A24 are their risk-taking projects (Everything Everywhere All at Once), genre-bending ideas (Death of a Unicorn), cinematic appearances, and cultural driving powers.

Logo Strategy:

The logo strategies are minimalism and timelessness. I think the logo shows A24's clean and contemporary take on indie films, while being very versatile to appear in different mediums like on-screen, posters, or merchandise. With "A24" being short and distinctive, it is both their logotype and logomark.

Logo Color:

A24 has primarily black and white for the logo, but chooses vibrant and shifting palettes in marketing, posters, and title cards that adapt to different films.

- They use black and white logos so that the audience can focus on the screens or prints.
- And the project-dependent palettes show flexibility and creativity of what the brand is capable of, aligning with their identity as a risk-taking, art-driven studio.

Logo Typeface:

The A24 logo uses custom lettering designed by Grand Army, with a high-contrast of thick and thin strokes and a geometric look. It feels modern but classic.

- The A24 logo blurs the line between serif and sans serif, having the distinctive serif on the letter "A" while the rest has clean cut ends. It perfectly shows A24's motto in blurring the edges of traditional genres.

BRAND ANALYSIS - 2



Brand - Whole Foods Market

Whole Foods Market is a U.S.-based grocery chain that focuses on natural, organic, and sustainably sourced foods. It is built for health-conscious consumers who value quality, transparency, and environmentally friendly practices.

They opened up the market for organic and natural foods, and brought up the consciousness of health and sustainability in grocery products.

Whole Foods market is positioned as a premium lifestyle market. They have strict standards around ingredients, labeling and sourcing for items sold at the store. They are also community-oriented with local food or brand partnerships.

Logo Strategy:

The Whole Foods Market logo is consistent, straight-forward, and creative.

- The letter "O" has a leaf figure on the top, making the letter look like a fruit. It not only represents the brand's goal of gathering fresh and natural products, but also added some playfulness into its classic design. The logo also has stayed consistent over years, just like their long-lasting sincerity to their customers.
- The logomark is a green circle with the brand name in it, looking like a stamp of a healthy lifestyle. The secondary logo is just the leaf "O" - very simple but distinctive.

Logo Color:

The color of the logo usually appears in green, and the secondary colors are white and black for contrast on prints.

- The logo being green reflects Whole Foods market's brand image of health, freshness and sustainability.
- When keywords like "organic", "freshness" and "eco-friendly" are mentioned, green is the first color that comes to mind. Therefore, green on Whole Foods market's logo is given its full potential.

Logo Typeface:

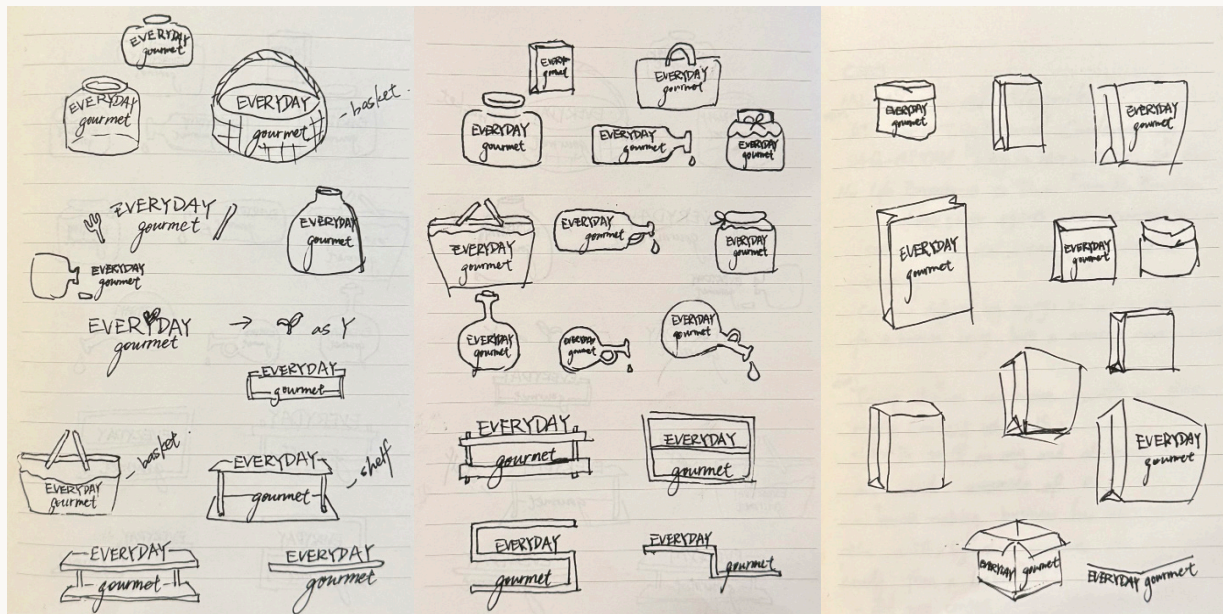
The logotype is in serif typeface, more specifically a custom typeface called Aime. It has smooth and thick stem lines which are just like vegetables. It also has very full and round counter parts of the typeface which are like harvested fruits. Overall, it is very classic yet cute, appealing to both loyal customers and younger generations.

LOGO PROGRESS

Logo Inspiration



Logo Sketches



Logo Drafts

EVERYDAY
gourmet

EVERYDAY
gourmet

 EVERYDAY
gourmet



EVERYDAY
gourmet 

EVERYDAY
gourmet 

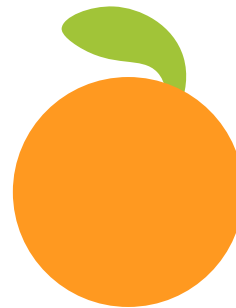


Final Designs

primary

EVERYDAY
gourmet 

secondary



invert color



packaging



clean

PROJECT 2 & 3

RESEARCH & BRANDSTORM

Website

1. Who is your website for?
 - For young professionals and families in Cambridge who are interested in shopping locally and discovering local gourmet grocery stores.
2. What does the user need or want when they come to your site?
 - Discover new grocery stores near them
 - Learn what makes these stores unique — their products, stories, and local connections
 - Find practical information like store hours, locations, or seasonal specials
 - Be inspired by recipes, products, or community events related to local food culture
3. How will they navigate the website to ensure they get what they need? (You can answer this question primarily through the creation of your Information Architecture)
 - There will be pages with different purposes - main information page with mostly event updates a little of , navigation page with a map of all the stores, product page with specialty items and the stories behind, an archive page with events, products and recipes the user saved
4. Conduct research into websites for organizations or brands. Do a light site audit for at least two websites. At least one should be similar to your own campaign (either in content or in type of website).

Eataly: https://www.eataly.com/us_en/nationwide-shipping

- Separation of Information: Sections are organized by functions: navigation, new announcement, shop by products, specific categories of products, recent events, eataly magazine articles, store explorer and footer.
- Visual Components: Large photos of ingredients, dishes, products and events. There is minimal color in the background, little off black fonts in a clean serif + sans-serif mix. The buttons and quick info fare in a highlight color, and the banner is in red.
- Direction Through Site: Clear calls to action ("Explore Now," "Get in Touch"), functional buttons ("Add to Cart"), and hero images leading into different categories on the page.
- Audit FigJam Info Arch

<https://www.figma.com/board/Vfz3liJYlo4EUssLJQSTk7/Eataly-Site-Audit?node-id=0-1&t=P9B5H9u0G6b4kaYY-1>

Notion: <https://www.notion.com/>

- Separation of Information: Organized clearly by introduction, update, function, word-of-mouth, and call to action. Each section has its own hero animation/illustration/product presentation. There is also an interactive section where the users can find out how much they are saving in using Notion. There are also quotes from companies that are using and benefiting from Notion. There are also buttons to explain its unique functions.
- Visual Components: The website has a clean and minimalistic style, with illustrations and animations showing product functionalities. There are highlighting colors in illustrations to add fun to the design. The buttons are in two colors, one is white and the other is blue, to differentiate the importance of different call-to-action buttons.

App

1. vWho is your app for?

- The app is for young professionals or families in Cambridge that seek quality and convenience in grocery shopping and would like to be involved in the gourmet food community and events.

2. What does the user need or want when they download your app?

- They want to be able to get information about the events, sales, and product information from these gourmet grocery stores. They also want the convenience of registering for events, compiling favorite recipes, and getting notified when their favorite product is in stock. They also want to be able to see what products others are recommending.

3. Define a specific use for the app.

- The app is to help the users to be able to connect with the community of the stores - reading about events, chatting with people about products and recipes, seeing new item drops, and making grocery shopping fun and easy.

4. Conduct research into apps that have a similar use to your own. Do a light app audit for at least two apps. At least one should be similar to your own campaign (either in content or in type of app). (Recommended Site: <https://screenlane.com/>)

Whole Foods Market App

- Separation of Information: divided into tabs of "Home", "Sales", "Order", "Products", "List".

- **Visual Components:** Home page is a QR code to scan in the store to link your purchase with Whole Foods and get extra sales with Amazon Prime. Product-related boxes consist of one clean image of the product, name, price and potential sales price. The background is white and clean while the banner is in signature green.
- **Direction Through App:** There is clear category navigation both in the bottom and "add to list". The users are well guided to learn about current sales.

Eventribe App

- **Separation of Information:** the main page tells information on events around you, with a map view toggle, a categorizing filter and free-text search. The rest is supporting functions - a tab for saved events, purchased tickets and an account page.
- **Visual Components:** Clean off-white background with minimal color - only few bright colors to highlight specific areas. There are pictures or illustrations of events, similar in the "saved" or "tickets" section.
- **Direction Through App:** It guides you to scrolling through events around you, or find the events you want to go and save them in your favorites. You can also easily find your purchased tickets and the event information.

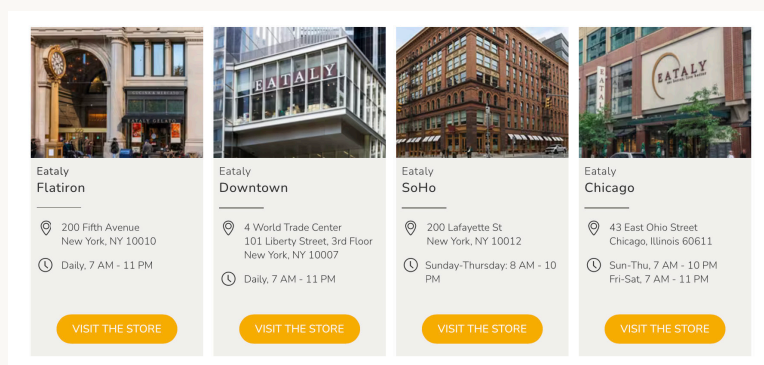
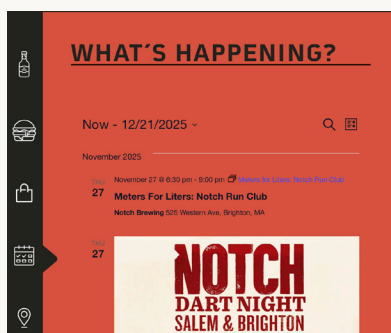
WEBSITE & APP DEVELOPMENT

Website Inspirations

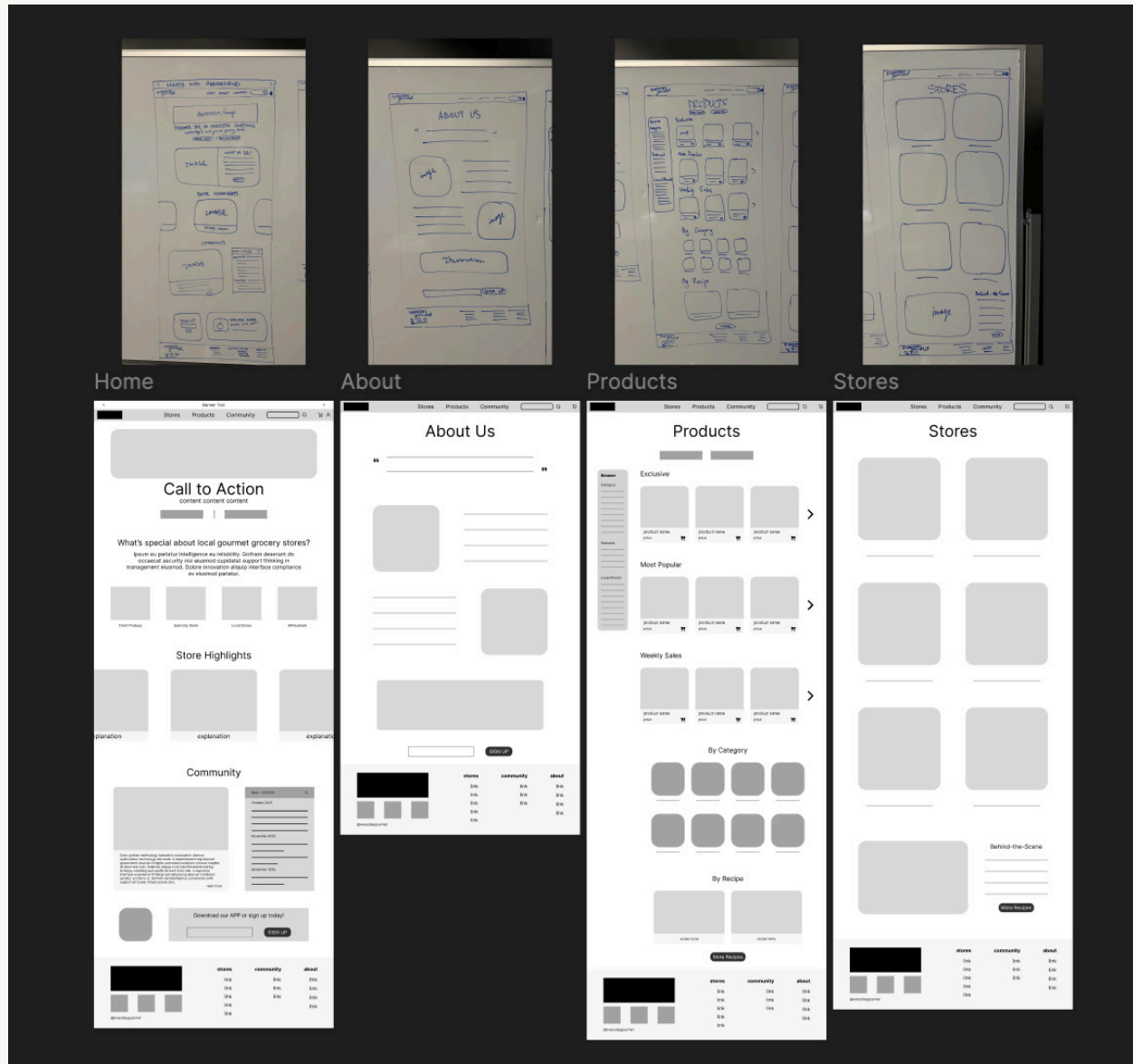


One workspace. Zero busywork.

Notion is where your teams and AI agents capture knowledge, find answers, and automate projects. Now a team of 7 feels like 70.

[Get Notion free](#)[Request a demo](#)

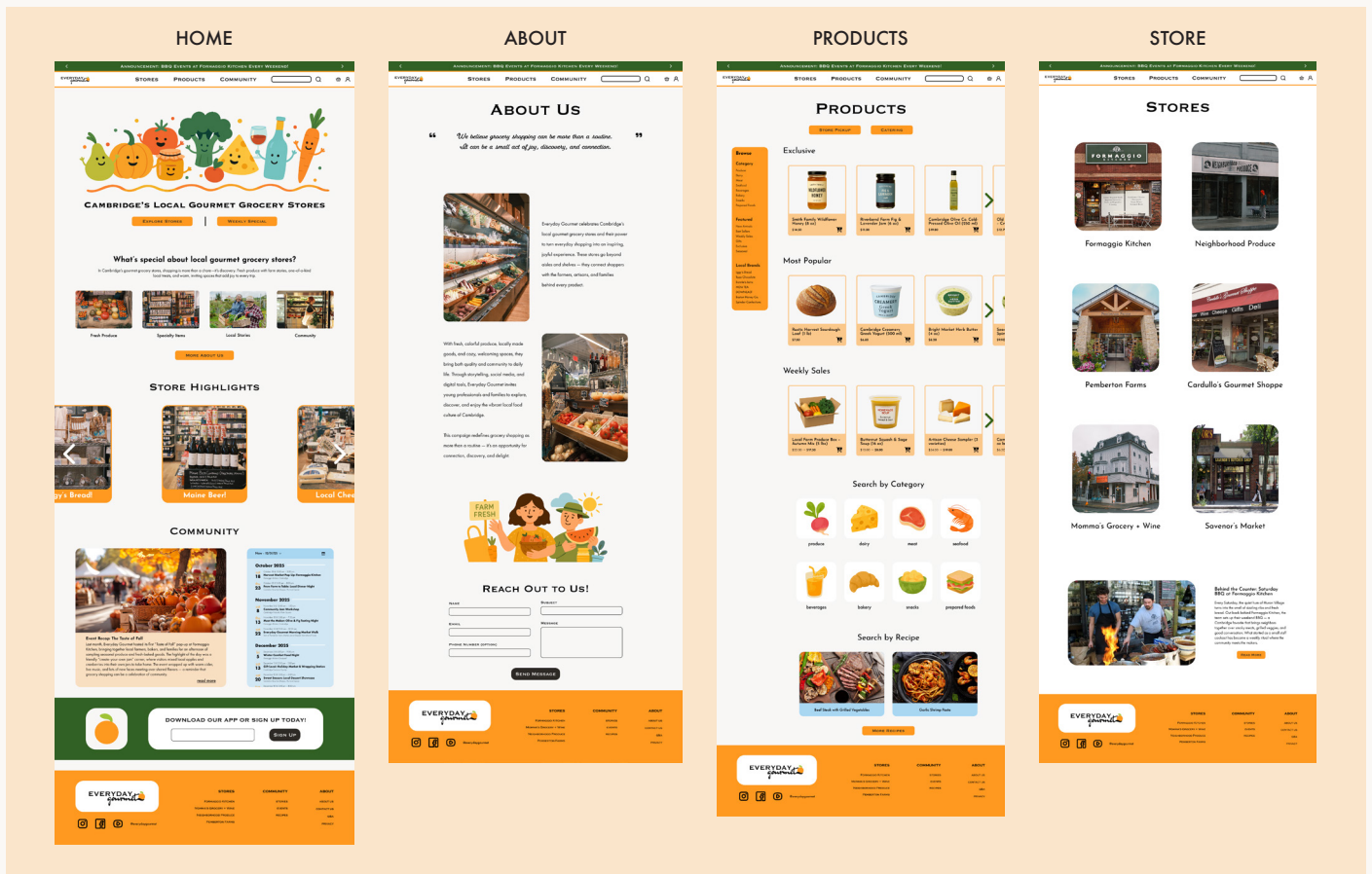
Website Sketches & Wireframes



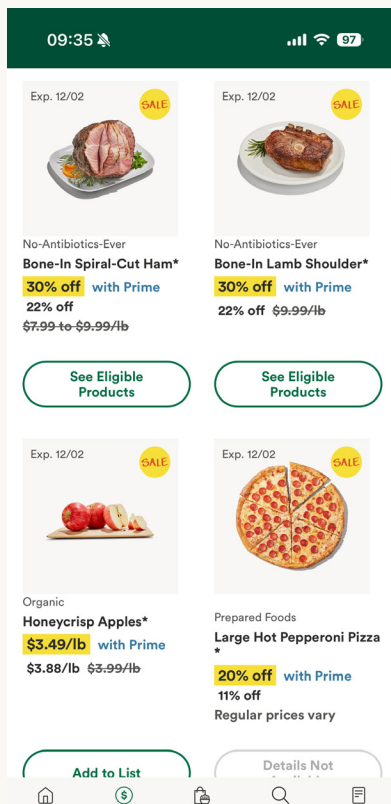
Website Final Designs



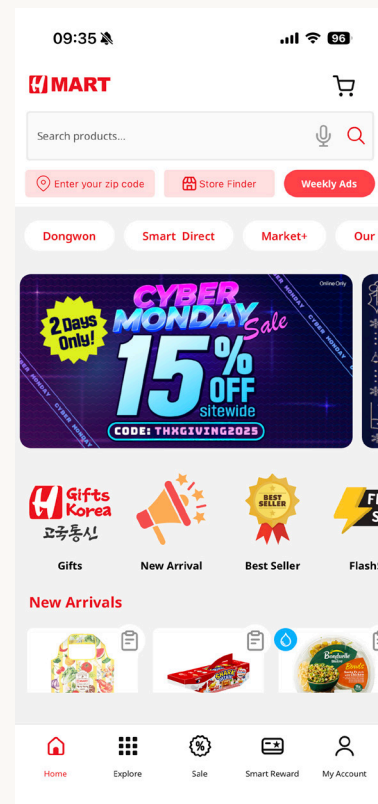
<https://www.figma.com/design/OQ6ifs4mUAY2bDut9il684/Everyday-Gourmet-Website?node-id=1-2&t=K5EBbYpGWZ8BXdrA-1>



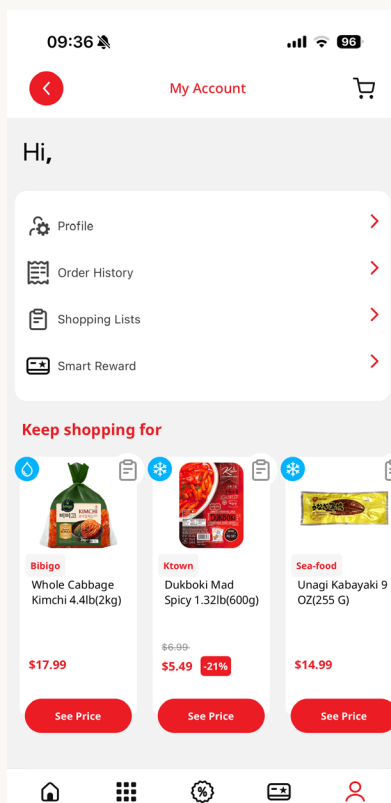
App Inspirations



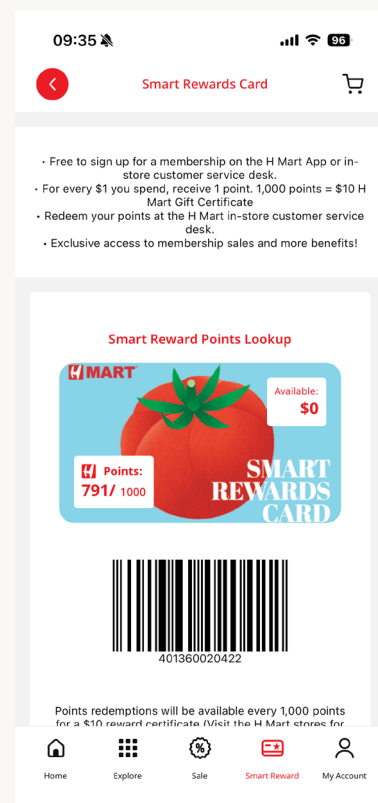
product
blocks



home
layout



account
layout

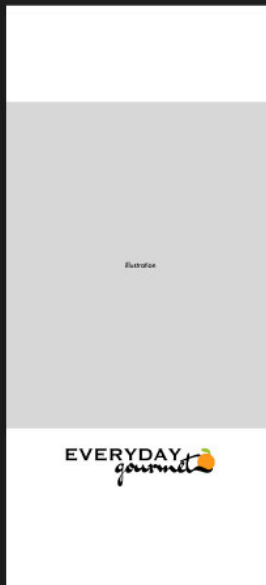


points
system

App Sketches & Wireframes



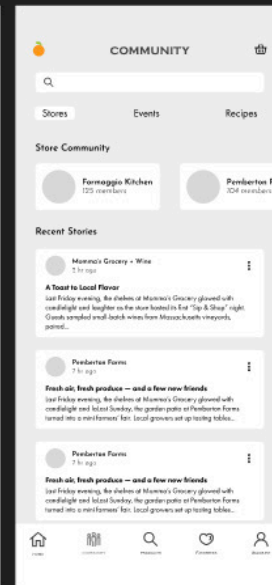
Splash



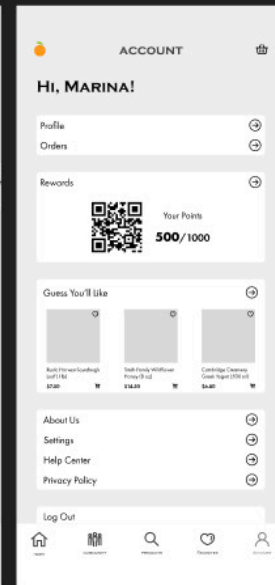
Sign In



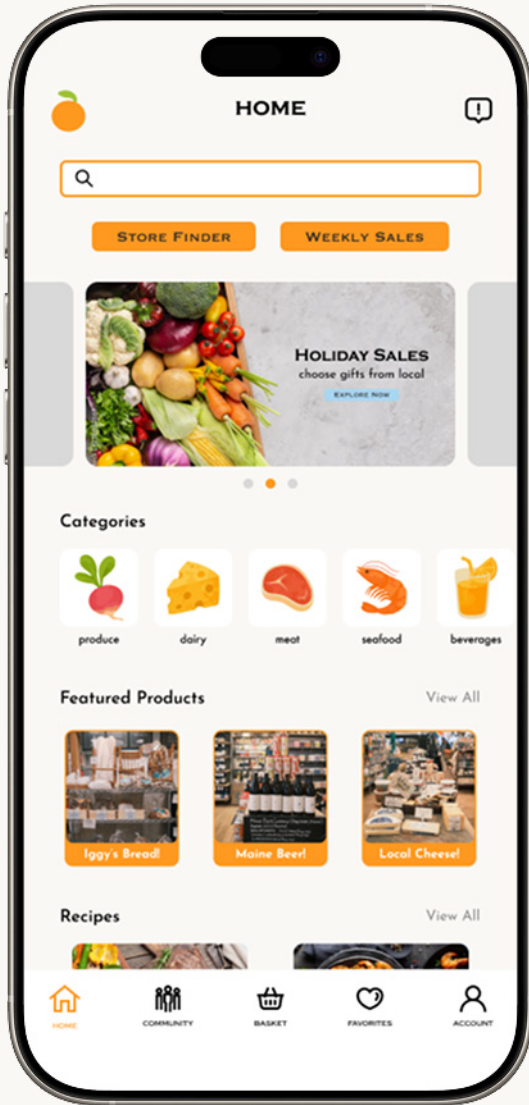
Community



Account



App Final Designs



<https://www.figma.com/design/GRPehrP1HKwTZy0kd2bimX/Everyday-Gourmet-App?node-id=1-2&t=9fp9muukuozfkChR-1>

